



Canadian developer Robert Campeau was ousted as chairman of his corporation after taking his enterprises deeply and dangerously into debt.

The bankers in question were, it need hardly be noted, among the most reputable on the North American continent. So were those who backed the glittering architecture of Mr. Donald Trump and his not greatly less extravagant adventure into aviation. A word of sympathy should be offered Mr. Campeau and Mr. Trump. The press and the public at large have reacted with a certain measure of delight to their transformation from aggressively avowed geniuses (in Mr. Trump's case, avowed not least by himself) to objects of condemnation. This is a highly selective attitude. Almost no mention has been made of the deeply defective judgment of the banks that financed these men. What in the world were they doing? Everyone who studies television knows that Citibank yearns to believe that Americans wish not only to survive but to succeed. Mention should also be made of their wish for banker solvency and good sense. Who, one asks, thought it wise to back these admitted adventurers with hundreds of millions of entrusted dollars? Over the country as a whole the same question arises as to those who, in error, optimism, stupidity, and forthright, generally unimaginative larceny, led the savings and loan associations into the greatest financial scandal of all time.